

Ember's Pizza Night





Ember's Pizza Night

A summer story from New England Crust

STORY & PICTURES BY NEW ENGLAND CRUST



NEW ENGLAND CRUST · SALT AIR & OPEN FLAME



*For every good dog who waits by
the oven.*

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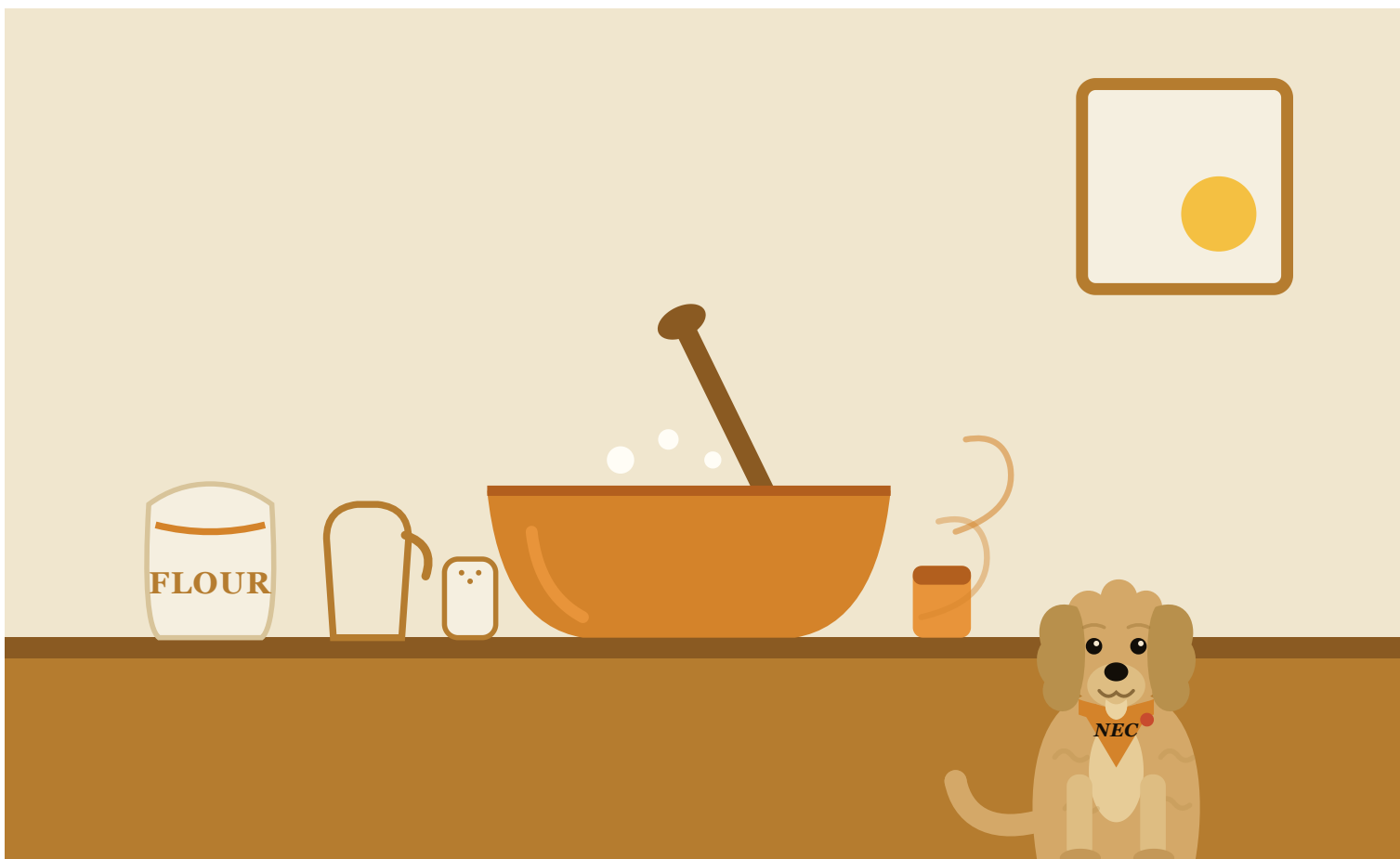
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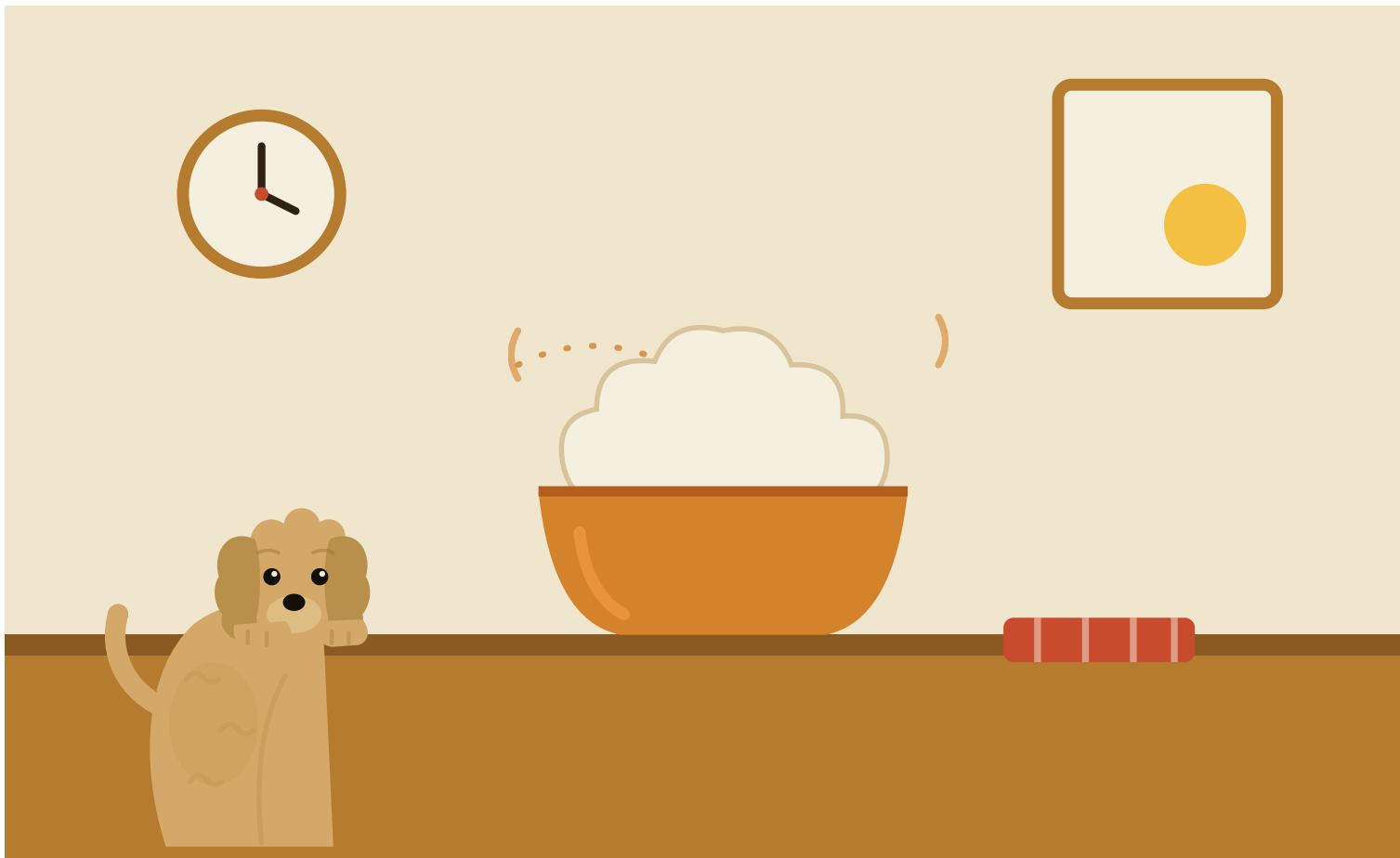
On a little street near the sea, where the salt
air tickles your nose, lives a fluffy golden dog
named Ember.



One summer morning, Ember heard the most
wonderful words in the whole wide world:
"Tonight is pizza night!"



Into the big bowl went flour, water, salt, and one tiny spoonful of sleepy yeast. Ember sniffed each one. Sniff, sniff!



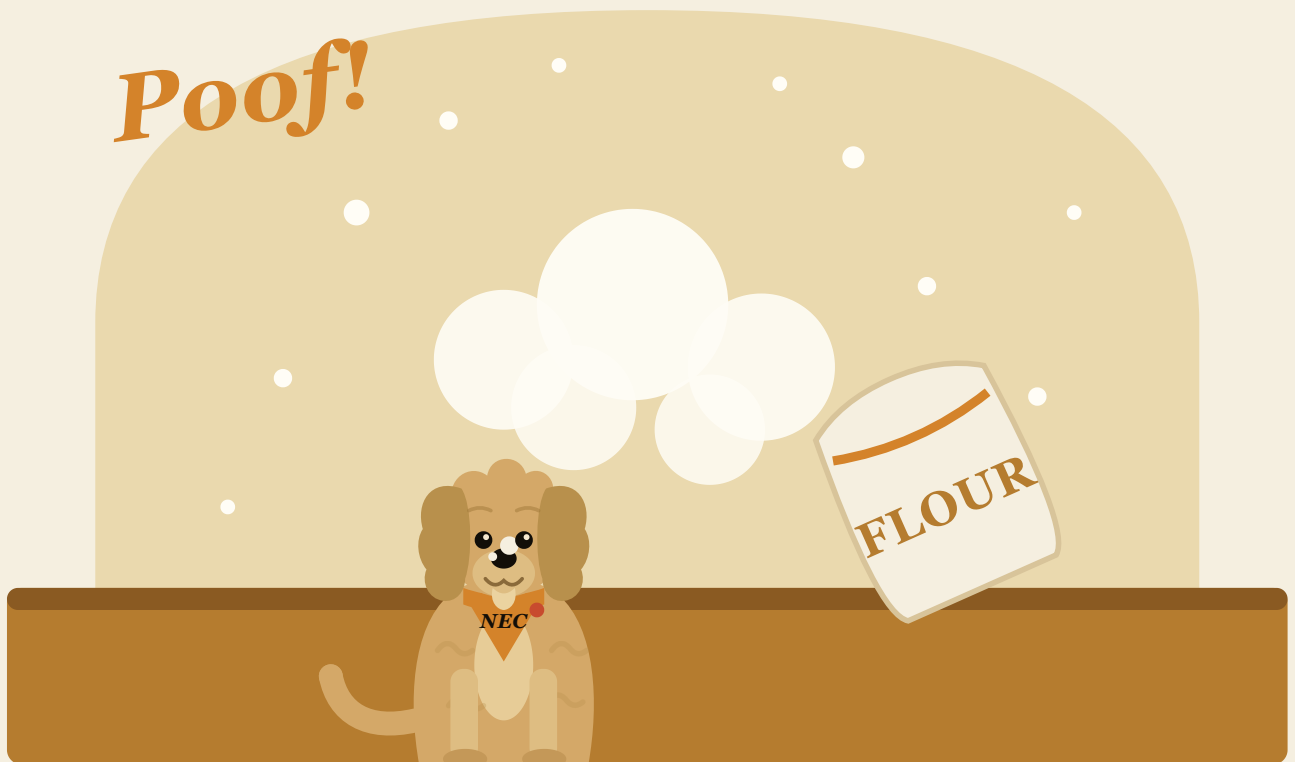
All day long, the dough grew in its bowl, puffy and round as a cloud. Ember watched. And watched. “*Not yet, Ember. Soon, soon, soon.*”



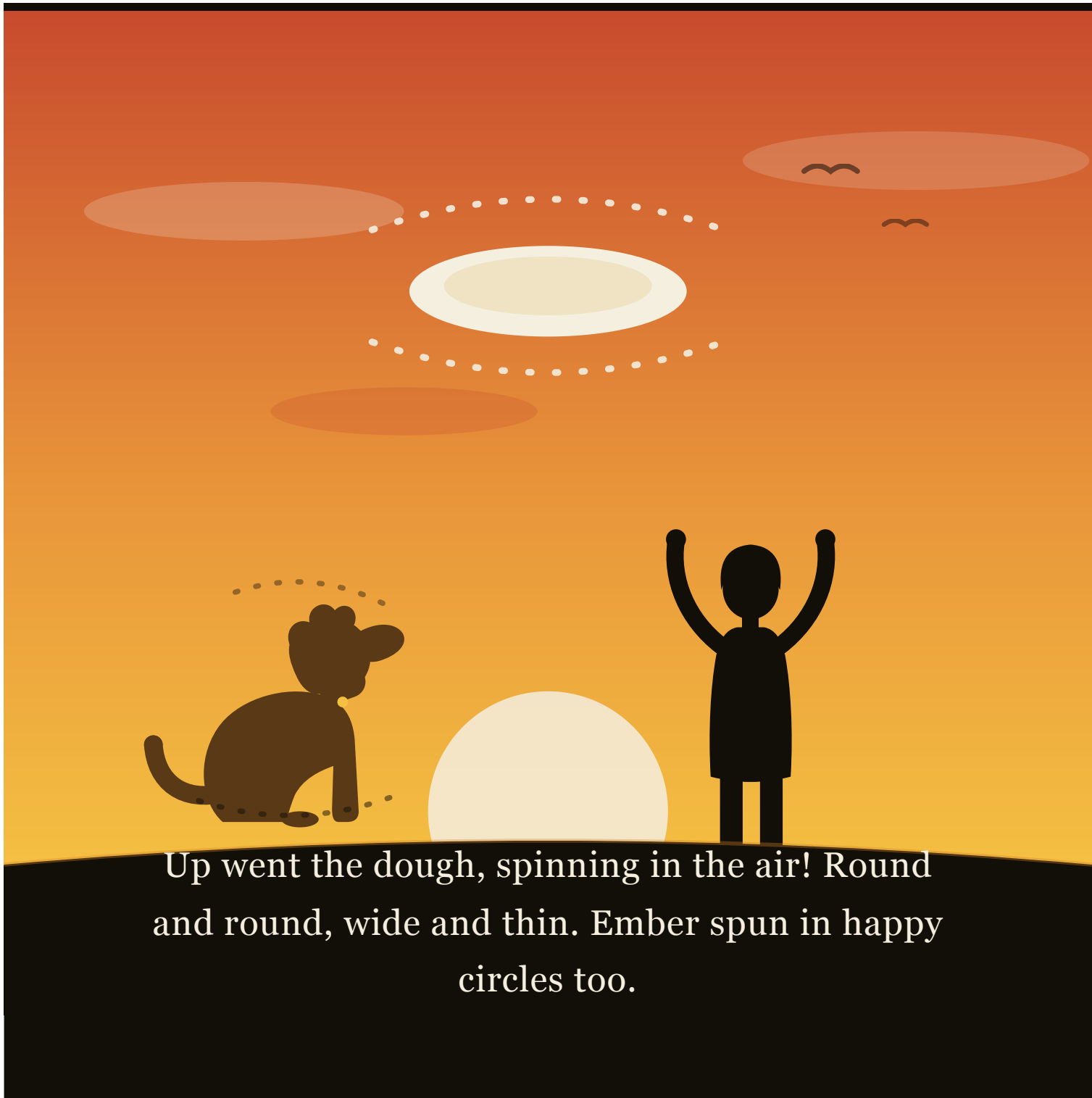
In the garden, Ember helped pick sweet red tomatoes and soft green leaves of basil. “*Good helper, Ember!*”



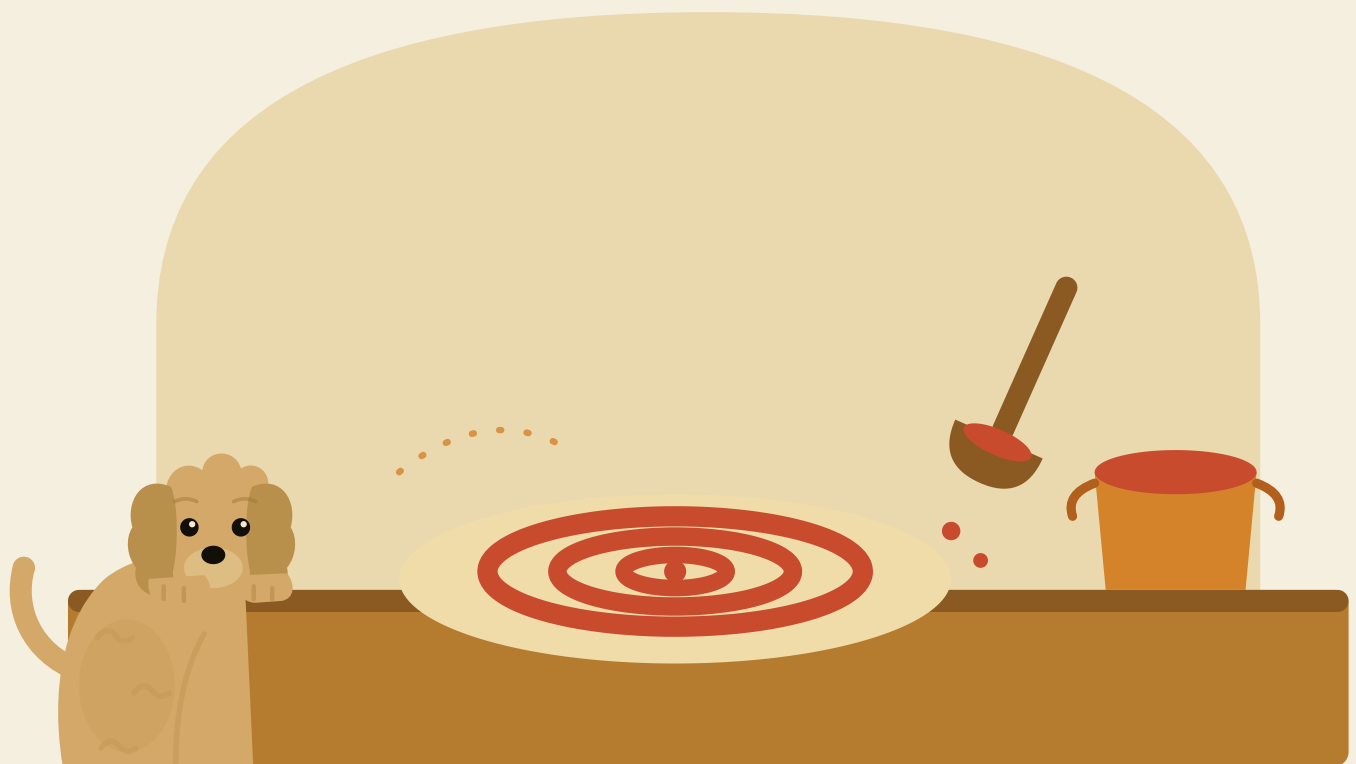
Then came the cheese, soft and white as sea foam.
One stray shred tumbled off the board — snap! —
right into Ember's mouth.



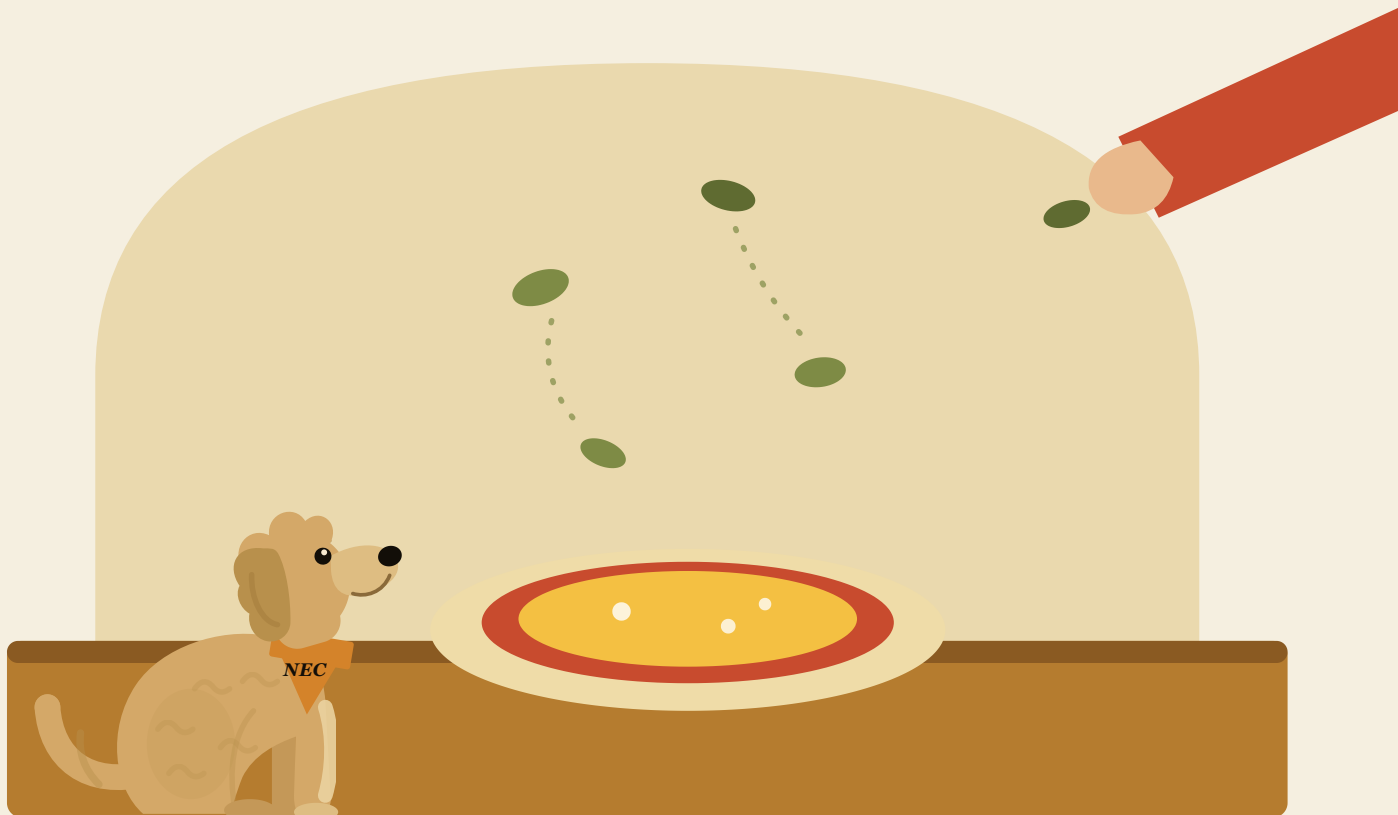
Then came the flour — poof! It floated down like snow in July. One big white dot landed right on Ember's nose.



Up went the dough, spinning in the air! Round
and round, wide and thin. Ember spun in happy
circles too.



Round and round went the shiny red sauce, in
circles all the way to the edge. Ember's nose went
round and round too.

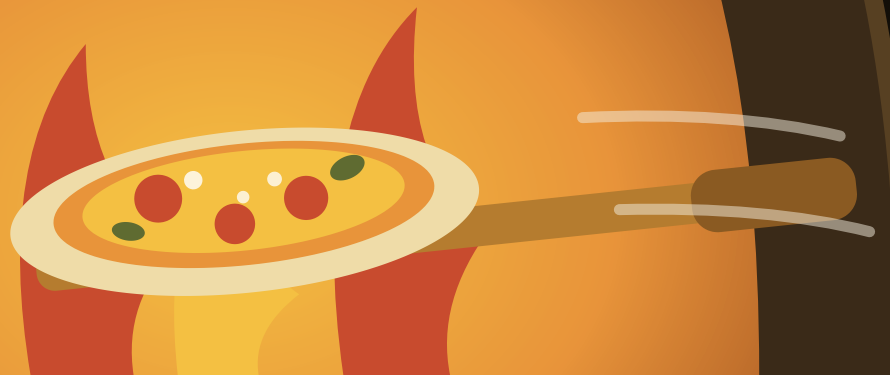


Last of all came the basil, floating down like little green boats. Ember watched every single one land. Perfect.



Outside, the little oven crackled and glowed,
warm and amber as a tiny sunset. Ember
sniffed the smoky air. “*Not yet, Ember. Soon,
soon, soon.*”

Whoosh!



Whoosh! The pizza slid in on the shiny peel.

The cheese went bubble, bubble, bubble.

“Not yet, Ember. Soon, soon, soon.”



Waiting is the hardest part when something
smells that good. Ember counted the sparks:
one... two... three...



The string lights blinked on. Fireflies came out to visit. Friends filled the picnic table, and Ember's happy tail went thump, thump, thump.

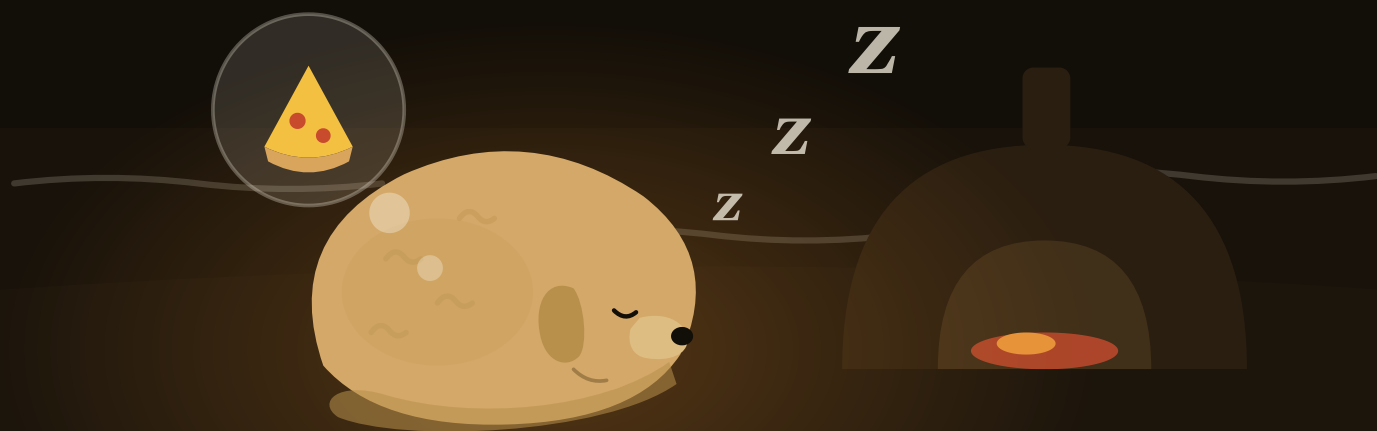
Munch!



And when the very last slice was gone — “*Now, Ember! Now!*” — came the very best part: a warm, crunchy piece of crust. Munch!



After the very last crumb, everyone walked down
to the shore. Ember sat at the edge of the sea,
nose up to the moon, happy from nose to tail.



The waves hushed. The stars came out one by one.
And Ember fell asleep by the warm little oven,
dreaming of salt air... open flame... and pizza night.

The End

*Sweet dreams, Ember. See you at the
next pizza night.*



NEW ENGLAND CRUST · SALT AIR & OPEN FLAME

FOR GROWN-UPS & SMALL HELPERS

Pizza Night at Home

A little recipe to share, from our hearth to yours.



- 1** Stir together 2 cups of flour, $\frac{3}{4}$ cup of warm water, a pinch of salt, and one spoonful of sleepy yeast.
- 2** Let the dough nap somewhere warm until it is puffy and round as a cloud.
- 3** Press it flat and wide. Spoon on the sauce, round and round, all the way to the edge.
- 4** Sprinkle the cheese. Float the basil boats on top.
- 5** A grown-up bakes it good and hot, until the cheese goes bubble, bubble, bubble.

And whatever you do... save the crust for your good dog.

A GAME FOR THE WAY BACK

Look Again!

Turn back through the pages. Can you find...



A red-sailed boat



A butterfly



Three fireflies



The crescent moon



A flour dot on a nose



The NEC bandana



*Made with salt air, open flame, and one
very good dog.*

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